

with app-style interactions and navigation. It also uses a full screen, unlike a browser. In addition, just like any application, it provides home screen icons as well.

Kanban boards are suitable not only for projects but also for ongoing tasks. Let us say that you have a team to attend to customer support tickets. This is not a project. It has no defined overall target that needs to be accomplished in a defined time frame. Tickets keep coming in and they need to be attended to on an ongoing basis. Kanban boards are well suited for this kind of work as well.

Project metrics in Kanban boards

Typically, people monitor throughput, cycle time and work item aging. Cumulative flow diagram (CFD) plots the number of cards at each stage of the Kanban workflow on a daily or even hourly basis. Increasing thickness of any individual band indicates a bottleneck in that stage of the workflow. This may be because of delays in that step or because of a hold up in the next step in the process.

Other open source tools in this space and why they are not recommended

RestyaBoard: The community edition is limited to a maximum of 10 users. It has 'Task' and 'To Do' management workflow only, and no Kanban workflow.

TaskBoard: A mailing list or a discussion forum is a 'must have' for any open source software. We can see how other people are using it and what issues they are running into. We can also post a question and get help from other users, if not the developers. Unfortunately, TaskBoard neither has a mailing list nor a discussion forum.

Taiga and Tuleap: Taiga and Tuleap, and also some of the other

Scrum project tools, have back-fitted Kanban capability into their existing tool. If you are already operating one of these, the balance of convenience may dictate that you try their Kanban features. However, if you are starting afresh, we recommend using one of the Kanban software tools.

Project team members get frustrated if leaders impose a heavy process that involves filling out many forms and filing innumerable reports. At the same time, it is impossible to achieve good coordination and communication by seat-of-the-pants management. Kanban is a lightweight tool that is simple to use and highly effective in project management. **END** 🐧

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